

C&W Campus Tree Tour

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Introduction

This tree walk includes 14 trees that are all publicly accessible and wrap around the BC Children's & Women's campus.

On the next page is a map of where all the trees are located. It is suggested you follow the numbered order they are in.

When arriving at each tree there will be a corresponding page in the guidebook to tell you about what you are looking at. After reading through the tree's information, take a moment to be present and observe the tree. Is there anything interesting you can see?

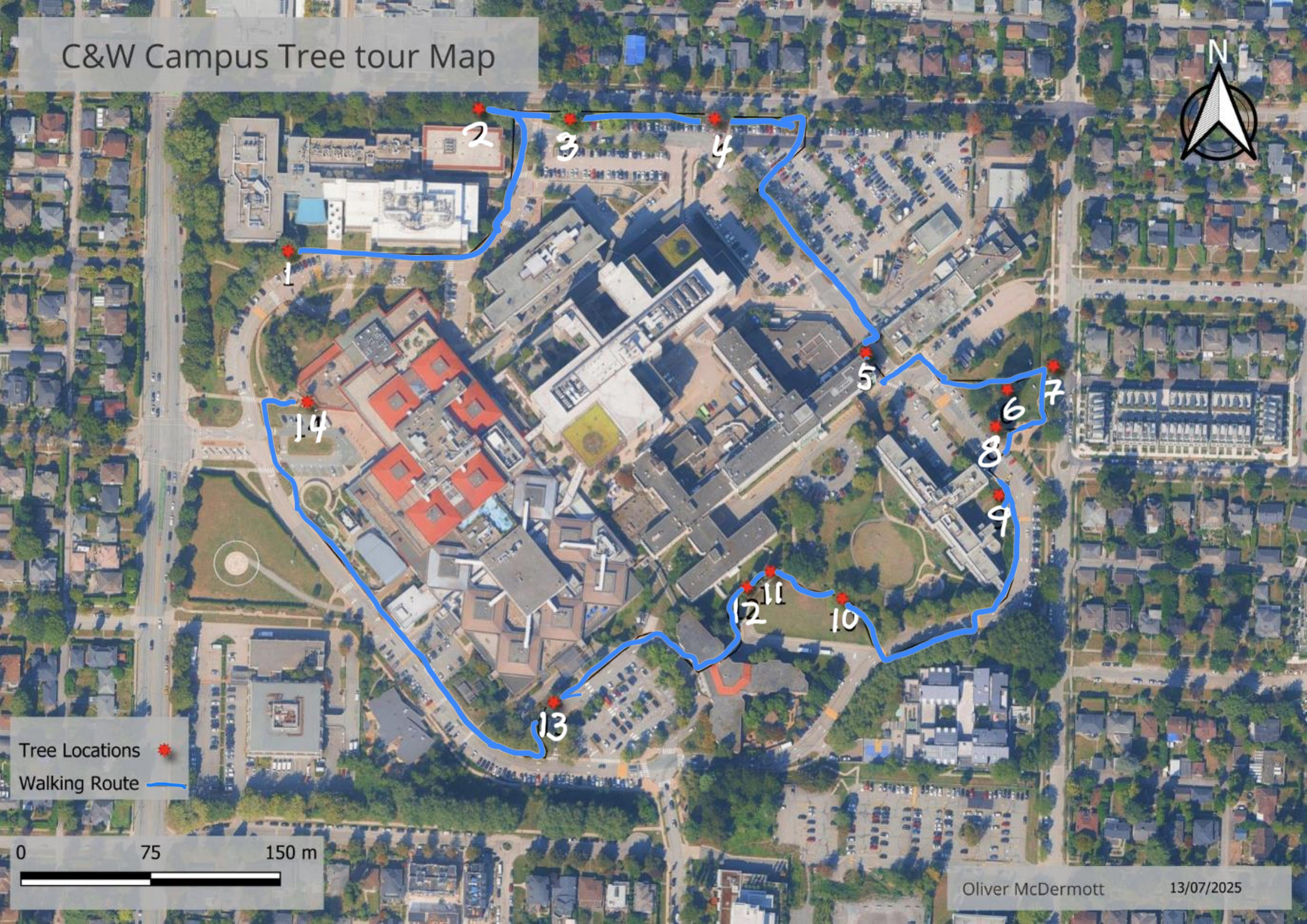
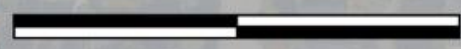
Please be mindful of other people in the space and potential hazards. Have fun!

C&W Campus Tree tour Map



Tree Locations 
Walking Route 

0 75 150 m



1. *Platanus x acerfolia*



Common name: London Plane tree

Country of Origin: England

Features to observe:

Bark flakes off in pieces and is a cream colour making it look like camouflage for a cappuccino.

Leaves resemble maple leaves which is often what it is misidentified as.

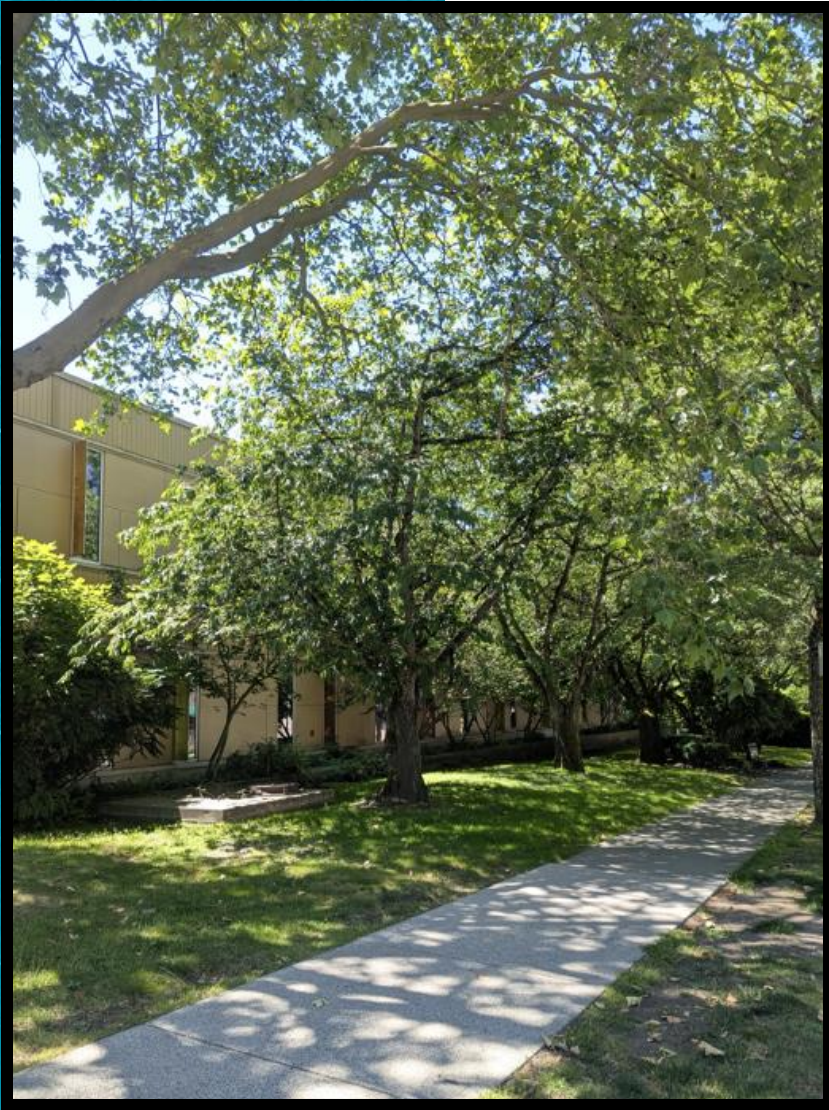
Fruit are clusters of many individual seeds each from an individual flower tightly packed together.

Fun Information

London plane trees are a hybrid species of *Platanus orientalis* from Southern Europe and *Platanus occidentalis* from North America. These species are thought to have hybridized in a garden in Oxford; however, some trace its origin to Spain which is why it also has the scientific name *Platanus x hispanica*.

There are many of these trees on the C&W campus, look out for others on this walk!

2. *Prunus serrulata*



Common name: Cherry blossom tree

Country of Origin: Japan, China, Korea

Features to observe:

Bark is varied depending on the variety. Can be rough with thick grooves or papery.

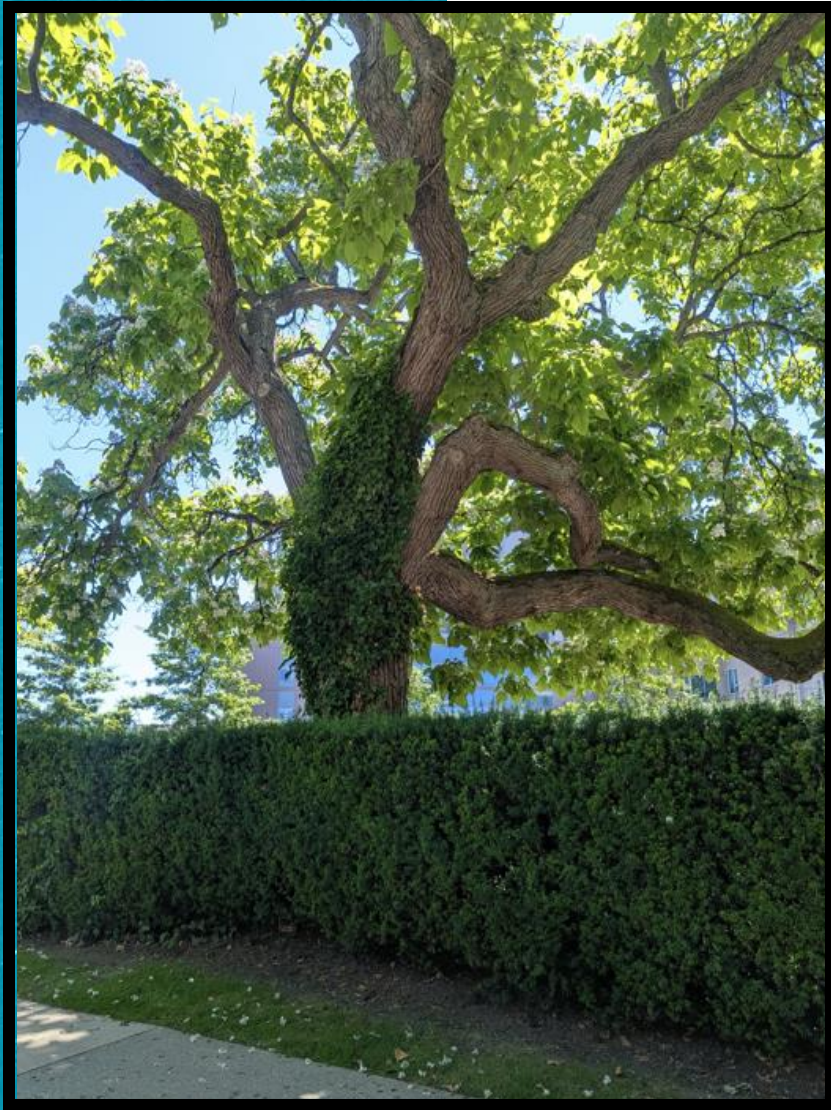
Leaves are a medium to dark green with serrated edges and a pointy (acuminate) tip.

Flowers during cherry blossom season will be fluffy and pink

Fun Information

In most cities all cherry trees are sterile---they produce pollen but not fruit. This is done to reduce the mess fruit cause when dropped, as well as limit food sources for pest species. These trees are usually also grafted which means the branches and the trunk are from different trees and have been connected.

3. *Catalpa speciosa*



Common name: Northern catalpa

Country of Origin: Eastern North America

Features to observe:

Bark heavily ridged bark with vertical channels.

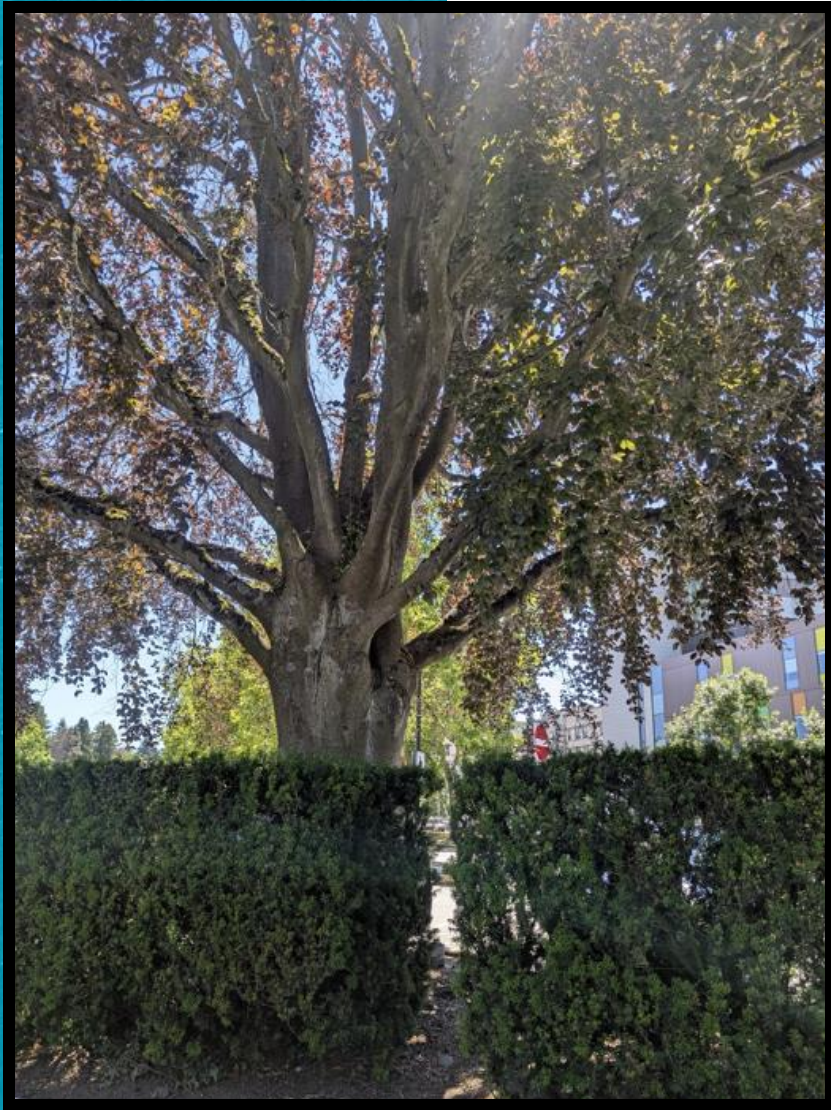
Leaves are very large and lime green in colour.

Fruit looks like long legumes but interestingly are classified as capsules.

Fun Information:

With large soft leaves and long legume-like fruits it is very easy to identify because of how unique it is. This tree also has whorled leaf arrangement instead of opposite or alternate arrangement which is much more common. Fishermen seek out this tree to find the catalpa moth caterpillar, which is one of the best live baits, giving the tree common names of worm tree, or bait tree

4. *Fagus sylvatica* 'Purperia'



Common name: Copper Beech

Region of Origin: Europe

Features to observe:

Bark is smooth and grey with specks of white that look like paint splatter.

Leaves are purple in mid summer to fall and have hairs (pubescent) on the margins and underside.

Buds are very long slender and pointy on the tips of branches.

Fun Information

This tree is a cultivar of European beech and is distinctive because of its copper or purple foliage. This mutation of the European beech was first noted in 1690 in a forest in Germany. 99% of all copper beeches in the world are thought to be descendants of this copper beech.

Later on in the walk you will see an example of the regular European beech!

5. *Cedrus deodara*



Common Name: Deodar Cedar

Region of Origin: Western Himalayas

Features to observe:

Bark grey and scaly.

Needles are in bunches giving it a dark green tufted look.

Cones are vertically oriented on the tree and only the cone scales fall off, not the whole cone.

Fun Information

Deodar cedar is one of 3 true cedars that exist. The group of plants that include red and yellow cedar are not true cedars. This tree also has interesting cones that look like vertical duck eggs on its branches.

6. *Quercus robur*



Common Name: English oak

Region of origin: Europe, West Asia

Features to observe:

Bark grey fissured often found covered in moss.

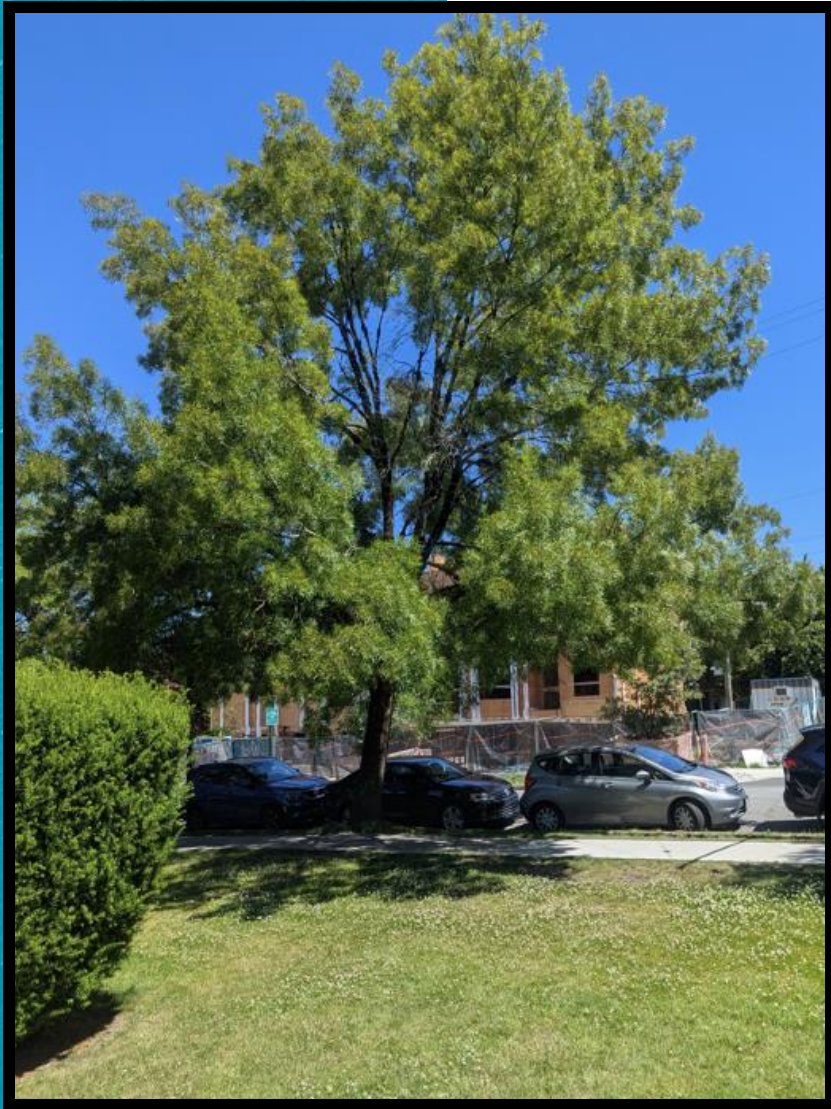
Leaves carry a rounded lobed shape with different shades of green on the top and bottom.

Acorns are at the end of long stalks coming off of the branches.

Fun Information:

English oaks have been one of the most common trees across Europe for a long time. Because of this it has had many uses such as leather tanning from the bark, flour from acorns, druid medicine, wedding ceremonies and strong timber.

7. *Fraxinus angustafolia*



Common Name: Narrow leaved ash

Region of origin: : Mediterranean

Features to observe:

Bark is smooth and grey with cracks as it ages and stretches.

Leaves are compound and have 7 to 11 leaflets.

Buds are small round and look like bits of chocolate.

Fun Information:

Narrow leaved ash is very soft looking because of its foliage and has beautiful colour gradients in spring and fall. However, it is considered a “weed” in some parts of the world including South Africa and Australia where it is pushing out native species of trees.

8. *Juniperus sp.*



Common name: Juniper

Region of Origin: North America

Features to observe:

Bark long fibrous strands with a red hue similar to Western Red-Cedar.

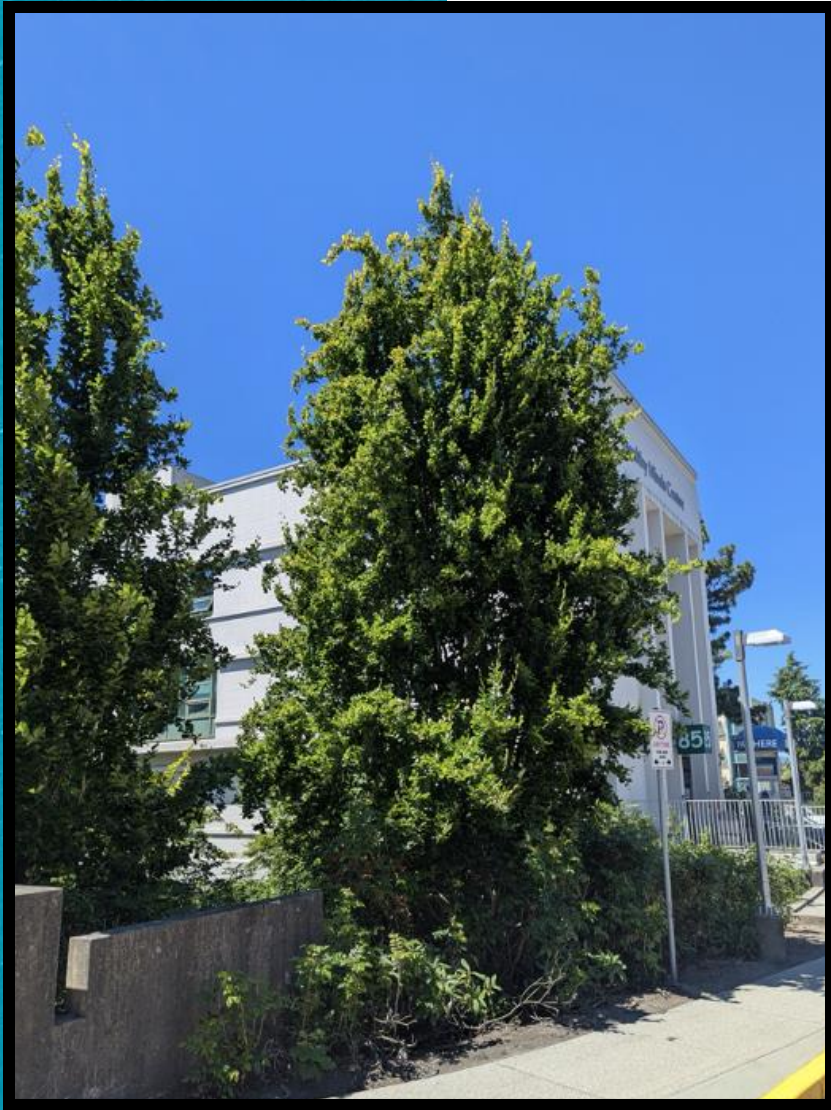
Needles are small and tightly packed. Some species of juniper have scales instead.

Cones are small balls that look berry-like often blue or green.

Fun Information:

Junipers display a large amount of phenotypic variation in their foliage and growth forms, even within single species. This is likely due to the harsher environments they are adapted for requiring more variation across spatial scales.

9. *Fagus sylvatica*



Common name: European beech

Region of Origin: Europe

Features to observe:

Bark is smooth and grey with specks of white that look like paint splatter.

Leaves are purple in mid summer to fall and have hairs (pubescent) on the margins and underside.

Buds are very long slender and pointy on the tips of branches.

Fun Information

This is the same species of tree that we saw earlier in our tree tour. This variety however has the standard green colouring on its leaves and is also much younger showing how different the morphology can be.

10. *Platanus orientalis*



Common name: Oriental plane

Region of Origin: Eastern Mediterranean

Features to observe:

Bark is smooth in smaller branches and rough along older sections of the tree.

Leaves look similar to maple leaves but are not closely related to maple trees.

Fruit are quail egg sized spiky balls.

Fun Information

This specific specimen is a descendant of the “Hippocratic tree” from Kos, Greece, where Hippocrates “Father of medicine” taught. This tree is also one of the species crossed to make the London plane tree we saw at the start of this walk.

See: <https://pediatrics.med.ubc.ca/2025/04/30/the-tree-of-hippocrates-at-bc-childrens-hospital/>

11. *Picea pungens*



Common name: Blue spruce

Region of Origin: Central/Southern Rocky Mountains

Features to observe:

Bark looks like dry crackly skin or scabs.

Needles are evenly spread around the branch and have a light blue colour from a waxy coating.

Cones are small and have wavy papery cone scales.

Fun Information

Despite its small native range this species is commonly planted in cities and has many smaller cultivars people use for gardens. Its light blue colour comes from a wax coating on the leaves that protects it against certain weather in its native habitat. The wax also has seasonal variation of its chemical composition.

12. *Picea abies*



Common Name: Norway spruce

Region of Origin: Northern and Central Europe

Features to observe:

Bark grey and scaly.

Needles are surrounding the branches evenly but have a dark green colourization

Cones are very long and large with small thumbnail shaped cone scales

Fun Information

Norway spruce is a very cold tolerant species often found in very snowy regions. Its narrow silhouette and droopy branches prevent the buildup of snow and physical damage to the tree. It is the source for “Spruce Beer” which was used to treat scurvy in mariners and soldiers prior to the 19th century.

13. *Pinus sylvestris*



Common name: Scotch pine; Scots pine

Region of Origin: Europe

Features to observe:

Bark is grey and plated like overlapping puzzle pieces.

Needles are in pairs of 2 and twist around each other

Cones are small with spiky points at the tip of each cone scale

Fun Information

Scotch pine can be identified by standing underneath and looking up. There will be an orange colouration coming from the underside of the branches

14. *Cunninghamia lanceolata*



Common name: Chinese fir

Country of Origin: China

Features to observe:

Bark stringy in long vertical lines

Needles are lanceolate and horizontally aligned

Cones female cones are like roses or woody pineapples.

Fun Information

Needles have 2 white “racing stripes” on the top and bottom which are stomata that allow for gas exchange. This is not really a fir but actually in the cypress family (Cupressaceae). It is a hard wood highly resistant to insect damage.